AC-13 Post-Arrest Temperature Management

MEDICAL-DIRECTOR APPROVED APP CONTENT | SOURCE-PDF REPLACEMENT | Reconciled October 16, 2026

Scope: Use after sustained ROSC in an adult as an adjunct to AC-10 post-resuscitation stabilization.

Fever prevention and temperature protection

1. Sustained ROSC	Open AC-10 and stabilize airway, ventilation, perfusion, rhythm, ECG, glucose, and cause-directed care.
2. Follows verbal commands?	If yes: continue AC-10 and prevent fever. If no: enter the temperature-management pathway.
3. Measure temperature	Use a reliable core or approved method when available; document site and serial trend.
4. Prevent fever/exposure	Remove excessive heat sources, maintain a normal environment, and prevent additional heat loss when cold.
5. No routine field cooling	Do not rapidly infuse cold IV fluid or initiate uncontrolled active cooling.
6. Spontaneously hypothermic	Prevent additional heat loss and avoid rapid active rewarming.

Key treatment and handoff

Item	Approved action
Monitoring	ECG, SpO2, BP/MAP, temperature, and EtCO2 with advanced airway; early receiving-facility notification.
Seizure	Treat under the linked seizure protocol and protect airway/ventilation; do not delay transport.

The goal is temperature protection and fever prevention, not a separate prehospital hypothermia-induction protocol.

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SAFETY, LINKED PATHWAYS, AND DOCUMENTATION

Safety checks

- AC-13 never replaces AC-10 hemodynamic, oxygenation, ventilation, ECG, glucose, or cause-directed care.

- Do not expose a cold patient to unnecessary heat loss or aggressively warm a spontaneously hypothermic patient.

Linked pathways

Pathway	Use when
AC-10	Post-resuscitation care
AC-04	STEMI/ischemia
UP-13	Seizure

Documentation and release control

- Document the presenting condition, focused findings, rhythm/ECG when applicable, all interventions with dose/route/time/response, serial vital signs, reassessments, destination decision, and notifications.

- This source PDF replaces the legacy imported sheet and matches the approved Claiborne EMS app content reconciled October 16, 2026.

- Use the linked protocol whenever the patient crosses into another clinical pathway. Follow agency release governance, training requirements, and current medication/device availability.